



PROCEDURE

Medication Safe Key Handling

Scope (Staff):	Medical and Nursing
Scope (Area):	ICAMHS (Pathways and Touchstone)

Child Safe Organisation Statement of Commitment

CAHS commits to being a child safe organisation by applying the National Principles for Child Safe Organisations. This is a commitment to a strong culture supported by robust policies and procedures to reduce the likelihood of harm to children and young people.

This document should be read in conjunction with this [disclaimer](#)

Only use this box if relevant (e.g. clinical document or available on an external website)

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Aim

To guide staff on the appropriate management, issuance, return and storage of Medication Safe Keys at Specialised ICAMHS sites.

This procedure to be read in conjunction with the [Medication Management - Specialised and Community Policy](#).

Risk

Lack of appropriate controls around access to controlled substances may result in non-compliance with legislation, theft / diversion or misuse of medications and reputational damage to CAHS, CAMHS and their employees.

Definitions

Authorised Staff: staff employed by CAHS involved in the procurement, distribution, storage, and disposal of medications.

- This includes Medical, Dental, Nursing, Pharmacy and Anaesthetic Technicians as defined by the WA [Medicines and Poisons Regulations 2016](#)¹, [Australian Health Practitioner Regulation Agency](#) (AHPRA)², and the WA [Medicines Handling Policy](#)³.

Controlled Medications: all Schedule 8 (S8) and Restricted Schedule 4 (S4R) medications.

Patient's Own Medication (POMs): any medication that is brought into an ICAMHS clinic by the patient / family.

Restricted Schedule 4 Medication (S4R): Schedule 4 medications subject to additional storage and recording requirements beyond those required for regular Schedule 4 medications.

- Also known as Schedule 4 Recordable medications. A list of these medications can be found in [Risk Based Requirements for Medicines Handling](#)⁴ (see [Medicines Handling Policy](#)³)

Schedule 4 Monitored Medicines (S4 Reportable Poisons): medications that are classified as drugs of addiction¹.

- Are considered to have a higher risk of abuse, misuse and physical or psychological dependence. Listed in Schedule 6 of the WA [Medicines and Poisons Regulations 2016](#)¹.

Schedule 8 Medication (S8): drugs of addiction.

- This category is for substances that should be available for use but require restriction of manufacture, supply, distribution, possession and use to reduce abuse, misuse and physical or psychological dependence. For further information refer to [The Poisons Standard \(the SUSMP\)](#)⁵.

Principles

- Medicines must be handled in accordance with the [Medicines and Poisons Act 2014](#)⁶, WA Health [Medicines Handling Policy](#)³ and local CAMHS policy. Any use of medicines outside lawful practice will breach legislation and serious penalties may apply.
- This procedure to be read in conjunction with the [Medication Management - Specialised and Community Policy](#).

Location of Medication Safe

- Location must be in a Medication Room

- Only S4R and S8 Patients' Own Medications (POM) must be stored within the safe.
- Only authorised staff may have access to the Medication Room with swipe card / secured access.

Safe Key or Code

POM Safe must be locked, and access controlled with either a key or digital code.

Safe Key (e.g. Touchstone)

- During operating hours of the clinic, when S4R and S8 POM are on site the keys must be on the person of an authorised person at all times.
- After hours, and in instances when S4R and S8 POM are not on site, the safe key must be stored in a lockable cupboard with a numerical lock, separate to the medication safe.
- Only authorised staff may have access to the lockable cupboard that stores the safe key.
- The code must be changed at six (6) monthly intervals.
- An access log detailing staff member name, time and date of removal and return of the key must be kept and available for audit refer to [Appendix 1: Key Access Log](#)

Safe Code (e.g. Pathways)

- Only authorised staff may know the digital code to open the safe.
- Code should be changed at six monthly intervals.

Safe Access

- Removal and addition of S4R and S8 POM to the medication safe must be done by two (2) authorised staff.
- Each transaction must be recorded in the appropriate register and witnessed and signed by two (2) authorised staff.
- On days when S4R and S8 POMs are on site, a safe count must be performed and documented in the register recording name, dose and volume of each medication by two (2) staff.
 - Refer to the [Medication Management - Specialised and Community Policy \(with particular reference to Appendix 1: Patients' Own Medication Storage Procedure\)](#)

References and related external legislation, policies, and guidelines (if required)	
1.	WA Medicines and Poisons Regulations 2016
2.	Australian Health Practitioner Regulation Agency (AHPRA)
3.	DoH MP139/20 Medicines Handling Policy
4.	DoH Risk Based Requirements for Medicines Handling Including requirements for Schedule 4 Restricted medicines
5.	DoH and Aged Care The Poisons Standard (the SUSMP) Therapeutic Goods Administration (TGA), 27 February 2025.
6.	Medicines and Poisons Act 2014

Related CAHS internal policies, procedures and guidelines	
	ICAMHS Medication Management - Specialised and Community Policy

Useful resources (including related forms)	
	DoH MP 0103/19 Medicines Discrepancy Report Form (Reporting of S4R and S8 Medicine Discrepancies Policy)
	CAHS Controlled Medicines Governance Framework
	DoH MP 0103/19 Reporting of Schedule 4 Restricted and Schedule 8 Medicines Discrepancies Policy and the Medicines Discrepancy Report Form
	CAHS Credentialing and Recredentialing of Medical and Dental Practitioners Policy
	CAHS Medication Safety Policy
	CAHS High Risk Medicines Policy
	CAHS Procurement, Distribution, Storage and Disposal of Medication Policy

This document can be made available in alternative formats on request.

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 Healthy kids, healthy communities Compassion Excellence Collaboration Accountability Equity Respect Neonatology Community Health Mental Health Perth Children's Hospital			

Appendix 1: Key Access Log

[illegible]